

Contoso Charts

CONTOSO CHARTS 4.4

User Guide

Install Contoso Charts, create your first chart, and keep it current with data from Excel

Windows · PowerPoint 2016 or later

Includes notes for Contoso Charts 4.3

Sample documentation. Contoso Charts is a fictional product.

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About this guide

This guide explains how to install Contoso Charts, create your first chart, and keep charts current with data from Excel workbooks. It covers Contoso Charts 4.4. Where Contoso Charts 4.3 works differently, a box labeled **Version 4.3** tells you what's different.

CHAPTER 1

What's new

Changes in each version of Contoso Charts. The newest version is first.

Contoso Charts 4.4

- **Refresh All Charts** now skips charts that aren't linked to a workbook and shows a summary, for example: "Refreshed 5 of 7 charts. 2 charts aren't linked to a workbook."
- The refresh shortcut is now Ctrl+Shift+R. Ctrl+Alt+R conflicted with a PowerPoint shortcut.
- The **Change Source** button and dialog box are now named **Change Data Source**.
- **Export to PDF** now supports up to 50 charts at a time.
- Contoso Charts 4.4 has a new installer, ContosoChartsSetup.exe. It requires 64-bit Windows 10 or Windows 11, PowerPoint 2016 or later, and administrator rights to install. PowerPoint 2013 isn't supported. See chapter 2, Installation.
- **Link to Excel** links a chart to a range in an Excel workbook, and the Welcome pane opens the first time you open PowerPoint after you install. See chapter 3, Getting started.

Contoso Charts 4.3

You can now refresh linked charts with the latest data from Excel. Use **Refresh Data** to refresh the selected chart, **Refresh All Charts** to refresh every linked chart, or press Ctrl+Alt+R. Refresh works with Excel workbooks (.xlsx). Charts don't update automatically.

For more information, see chapter 4, Refresh charts.

CHAPTER 2

Installation

This chapter explains how to install, update, and uninstall Contoso Charts 4.4.

Requirements

Requirement	Details
Operating system	Windows 10 or Windows 11, 64-bit
PowerPoint version	PowerPoint 2016 or later. Contoso Charts 4.4 doesn't support PowerPoint 2013.
Permissions	Installing Contoso Charts 4.4 requires administrator rights on the computer.

The installer is a single file, ContosoChartsSetup.exe. Download it from the Contoso Charts download page. If your IT team manages installations, it can get the file from the admin portal. No MSI package is available for Contoso Charts 4.4.

Before you install

- You need administrator rights on the computer. Without them, setup shows "You need administrator rights to install Contoso Charts." and stops.
- Close PowerPoint before you run setup. If PowerPoint is open, setup shows "Close PowerPoint to continue." and waits.

Install

1. Close PowerPoint.
2. Double-click ContosoChartsSetup.exe.
3. On the Welcome page, select **Next**.
4. Read the license agreement, select **I accept the agreement**, and then select **Next**.
5. Keep the default install location, or select **Browse** to choose another folder. Then select **Next**.
6. Select **Install**. A progress bar shows the installation status.
7. Select **Finish**.
8. Open PowerPoint. The **Contoso Charts** tab appears on the ribbon. The first time you open PowerPoint, the Welcome pane opens on the right. See chapter 3, Getting started.

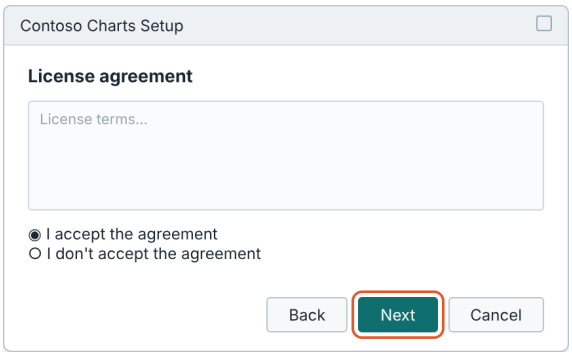


Figure 1. The license agreement page in Contoso Charts Setup (step 4)

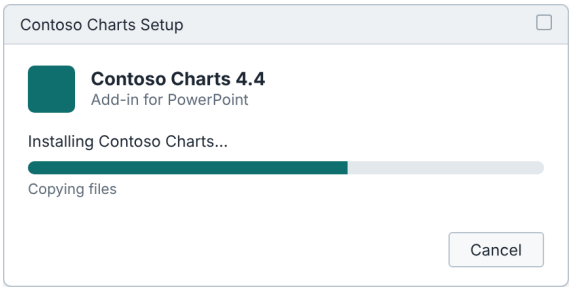


Figure 2. Contoso Charts Setup during installation (step 6)

Update

To update from Contoso Charts 4.3, run the Contoso Charts 4.4 setup file, ContosoChartsSetup.exe. Setup upgrades Contoso Charts in place. Close PowerPoint first. If PowerPoint is open, setup shows "Close PowerPoint to continue." and waits. Setup shows the same pages as a new installation and keeps the install location.

You don't need to uninstall Contoso Charts 4.3 first. Existing linked charts keep their links after the update.

To update from a version earlier than Contoso Charts 4.3, uninstall it first, and then install Contoso Charts 4.4.

Uninstall

On Windows 11:

1. Open **Settings**.
2. Select **Apps**.
3. Select **Installed apps**.
4. For **Contoso Charts**, select **More (...)**.
5. Select **Uninstall**.

On Windows 10:

1. Open **Control Panel**.
2. Select **Programs**.
3. Select **Programs and Features**.
4. Select **Contoso Charts**.
5. Select **Uninstall**.

CHAPTER 3

Getting started

After you install Contoso Charts, the **Contoso Charts** tab appears on the PowerPoint ribbon. This chapter shows the tab, then walks you through creating a chart, linking it to Excel, and exporting it.

Workflow

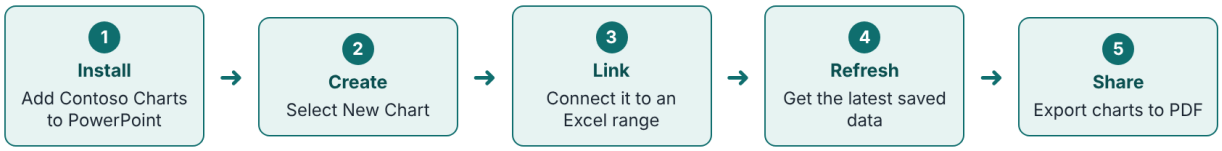


Figure 3. From installation to a shared PDF

The Contoso Charts tab

The **Contoso Charts** tab organizes its buttons into four groups. **Link to Excel** and the Welcome pane are new in Contoso Charts 4.4.

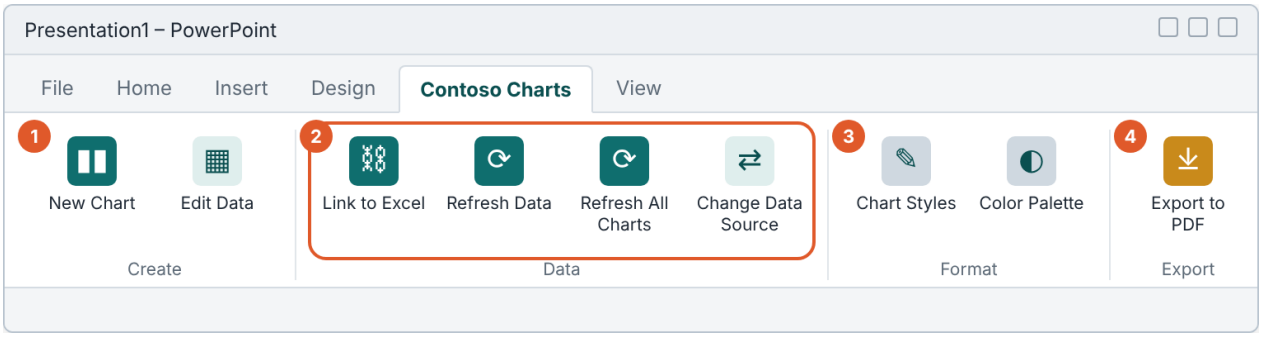


Figure 4. The Contoso Charts tab, with the Data group highlighted

#	Group	Buttons
1	Create	**New Chart**, **Edit Data**
2	Data	**Link to Excel**, **Refresh Data**, **Refresh All Charts**, **Change Data Source**
3	Format	**Chart Styles**, **Color Palette**
4	Export	**Export to PDF**

Edit Data opens the data grid. For the **Data** group, see Link to Excel in this chapter, chapter 4, Refresh charts, and chapter 5, Data sources.

Welcome pane

The Welcome pane opens on the right the first time you open PowerPoint after you install Contoso Charts. It opens only that first time, and you can't reopen it in Contoso Charts 4.4. Its **Create your first chart** button does the same thing as **New Chart** in the **Create** group.

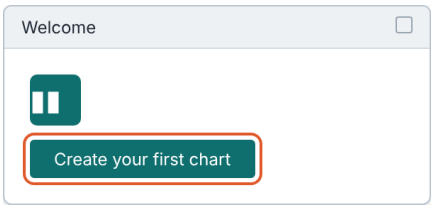


Figure 5. The Welcome pane

Create a chart

1. On the **Contoso Charts** tab, in the **Create** group, select **New Chart**. The **Choose a Chart Type** dialog box opens.
2. In the **Choose a Chart Type** dialog box, select **Column**, **Bar**, **Line**, **Pie**, or **Area**.
3. Select **Insert**. The chart appears on the slide with sample data.

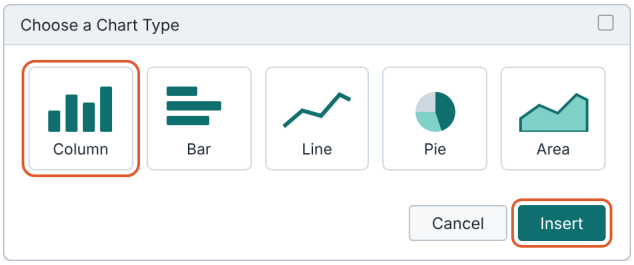


Figure 6. The Choose a Chart Type dialog box

Add your data

To replace the sample data, select the chart, and then select **Edit Data**. The data grid opens. To use data from an Excel workbook instead, see Link to Excel.

Link to Excel

1. Select the chart.
2. On the **Contoso Charts** tab, in the **Data** group, select **Link to Excel**. The **Link to Excel** dialog box opens.
3. In the **Link to Excel** dialog box, select **Browse**, and then select the workbook. Only Excel workbooks (.xlsx) are supported.
4. Select the sheet, and then enter the range in the **Range** box, for example A1:D12.
5. Select **OK**. The chart shows the data from that range.

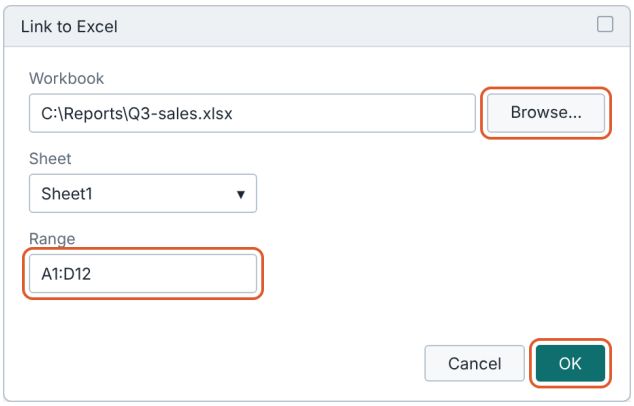


Figure 7. The Link to Excel dialog box

After you link a chart, **Edit Data** is unavailable for that chart. To change the data, edit it in Excel, and then refresh the chart. Linked charts don't update automatically. See chapter 4, Refresh charts.

Export to PDF

1. On the **Contoso Charts** tab, in the **Export** group, select **Export to PDF**. The **Export Charts to PDF** dialog box opens.
2. Under **Charts to export**, select **All charts in presentation** or **Selected charts**.
3. Under **Page size**, select **A4** or **Letter**. The default is Letter.
4. Optional: Clear **Include chart titles**, or select **Open after export**.
5. Select **Export**. In the **Save As** dialog box, choose a location and file name, and then select **Save**. A progress bar shows the export status.

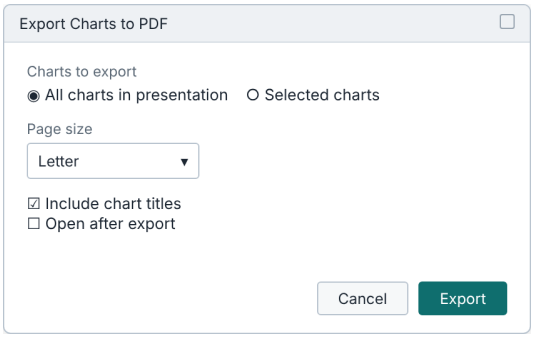


Figure 8. The Export Charts to PDF dialog box

> **Note** You can export up to 50 charts at a time (20 in Contoso Charts 4.3). Exported charts are static images, so you can't edit them in the PDF. **Export to PDF** is unavailable until the presentation has a chart.

CHAPTER 4

Refresh charts

Refresh a linked chart to update it with the current data from its Excel workbook. Refresh is manual, so charts don't update automatically when the Excel data changes. Refresh keeps the chart's formatting, such as colors, fonts, and titles.



Figure 9. Refresh updates the data and keeps the formatting

Prerequisites

- Contoso Charts 4.3 or later on Windows. Refresh isn't available on Mac.
- A chart linked to an Excel workbook (.xlsx). You can't refresh a chart whose data you entered in the Contoso Charts data grid.
- A saved workbook. If the workbook is open in Excel, save it before you refresh. Refresh reads the last saved version and doesn't include unsaved changes.

Refresh one chart

1. Select the chart.
2. On the **Contoso Charts** tab, in the **Data** group, select **Refresh Data**. The chart updates with the current data from its workbook.

> **Tip** You can also select the chart and press Ctrl+Shift+R. In Contoso Charts 4.3, press Ctrl+Alt+R. **Refresh Data** is unavailable when no chart is selected, or when the selected chart uses data from the data grid.

Refresh all charts

- On the **Contoso Charts** tab, in the **Data** group, select **Refresh All Charts**. Every linked chart in the presentation refreshes. Refresh All Charts skips charts that aren't linked to a workbook and shows a summary. The summary is new in Contoso Charts 4.4.



Figure 10. The summary after Refresh All Charts

Messages

Message	Cause	What to do
"Can't find the linked workbook. Use Change Data Source to relink it."	Someone moved or deleted the linked workbook.	Relink the chart. See chapter 5, Data sources.
"Some data wasn't added because the chart is full."	The workbook has more rows than the chart has series slots. Each chart has 20 series slots, and you can't add more. Refresh ignores the extra rows.	Split the data across two charts, or remove rows.

CHAPTER 5

Data sources

Use **Change Data Source** to choose the workbook and range that a linked chart uses.

Change the source

1. Select the chart.
2. On the **Contoso Charts** tab, in the **Data** group, select **Change Data Source**.
3. In the **Change Data Source** dialog box, browse to the workbook, select the range, and then select **OK**.

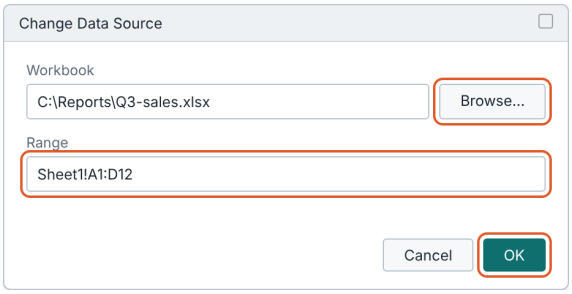


Figure 11. The Change Data Source dialog box

> **Version 4.3** In Contoso Charts 4.3, the button and dialog box are named **Change Source**.

Relink a chart

If someone moved the linked workbook, follow the steps in Change the source, and browse to the workbook's new location.

CHAPTER 6

Troubleshooting

Use this chapter when a linked chart still shows old data after you edit its Excel workbook. Each section describes one cause and its fix.

Manual refresh

Refresh is manual. Charts don't update automatically when the Excel data changes.

1. Select the chart you want to update.
2. On the **Contoso Charts** tab, in the **Data** group, select **Refresh Data**. The chart updates with the current data from its Excel workbook.

To refresh every linked chart, select **Refresh All Charts**.

Unsaved changes

Refresh reads the last saved version of the workbook and doesn't include unsaved changes.

1. In Excel, save the workbook.
2. In the presentation, select the chart, and then select **Refresh Data**. The chart updates with the saved data.

No chart selected

Refresh Data is unavailable until you select a chart. Select the chart, and then select **Refresh Data**.

Data grid charts

You can't refresh charts with data entered in the Contoso Charts data grid, so **Refresh Data** is unavailable for these charts. To fix this, link the chart to an Excel workbook. See chapter 3, Link to Excel.

Missing workbook

If someone moved or deleted the linked workbook, you see the message in figure 12. To fix this, relink the chart by using **Change Data Source**. See chapter 5, Data sources.

> **Version 4.3** In Contoso Charts 4.3, the message says "Use Change Source to relink it."

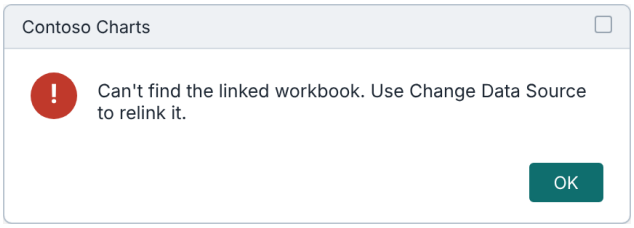


Figure 12. The message for a missing workbook

CHAPTER 7

Reference

Messages and keyboard shortcuts.

Error messages

Message	Cause	How to fix it
"Can't find the linked workbook. Use Change Data Source to relink it."	Someone moved or deleted the linked workbook.	Relink the chart. See chapter 5, Data sources.
"Some data wasn't added because the chart is full."	The workbook has more rows than the chart has series slots. Each chart has 20 series slots.	Split the data across two charts, or remove rows.

Version 4.3 In Contoso Charts 4.3, the first message says "Use Change Source to relink it."

Keyboard shortcuts

These shortcuts work on the **Contoso Charts** tab.

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl+Shift+R	Refresh the selected chart's data from Excel (Contoso Charts 4.4 and later).
Ctrl+Alt+R	Refresh the selected chart's data from Excel (Contoso Charts 4.3).
Ctrl+Alt+E	Open the **Export Charts to PDF** dialog box.

Note Refresh and its shortcuts are available on Windows only.